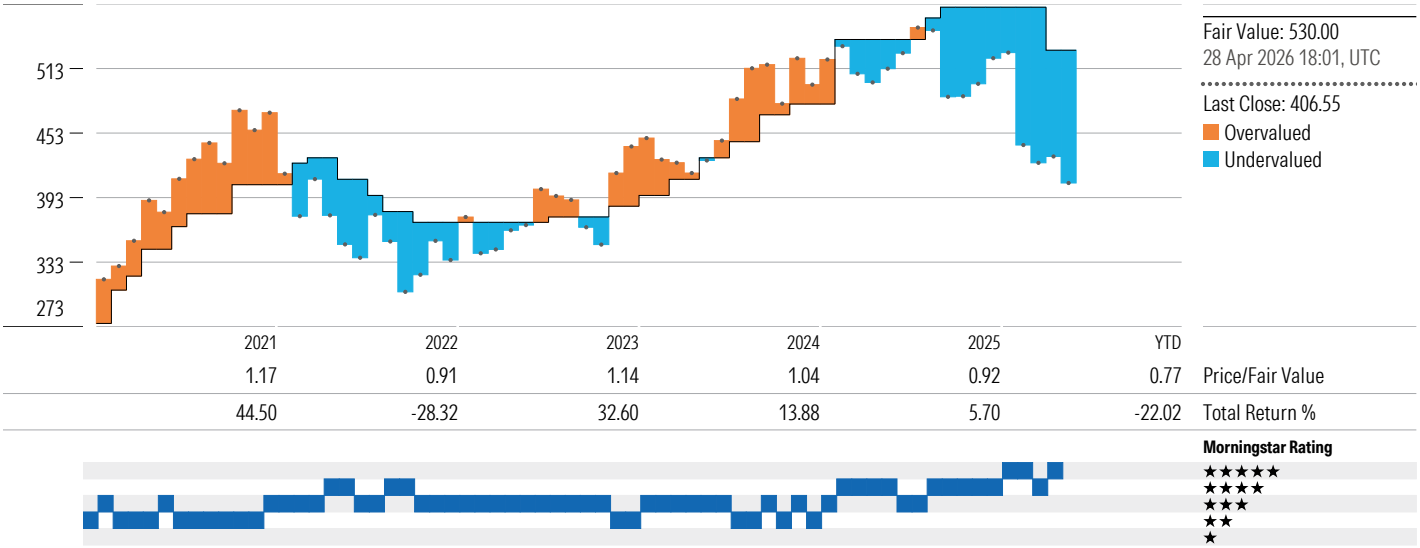
S&P Global Inc SPGI ★★★★★ 13 May 2026 21:23, UTC

Last Price	Fair Value Estimate	Price/FVE	Market Cap	Economic Moat™	Equity Style Box	Uncertainty	Capital Allocation	ESG Risk Rating Assessment[1]
406.55 USD 13 May 2026	530.00 USD 28 Apr 2026 23:01, UTC	0.77	120.34 USD Bil 13 May 2026	Wide	Large Blend	Low	Exemplary	13 May 2026 05:00, UTC

Price vs. Fair Value



	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	YTD
Price/Fair Value	1.17	0.91	1.14	1.04	0.92	0.77
Total Return %	44.50	-28.32	32.60	13.88	5.70	-22.02

Morningstar Rating

★★★★★
★★★★
★★★
★★
★

Total Return % as of 13 May 2026. Last Close as of 13 May 2026. Fair Value as of 28 Apr 2026 18:01, UTC.

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The primary analyst covering this company does not own its stock.

[1]The ESG Risk Rating Assessment is a representation of Sustainalytics' ESG Risk Rating.

S&P Global Earnings: Mostly Steady Start to 2026; Uncertainty Rating to Medium

Analyst Note Rajiv Bhatia, CFA, Equity Analyst, 28 Apr 2026

S&P Global is off to a solid start in 2026, with first-quarter organic revenue growth of 9% and adjusted operating profit growth of 12%. S&P Global maintained its firmwide 2026 outlook of 6%-8% organic revenue growth and adjusted EPS of $19.40-$19.65. Shares rose 3% in intraday trading on April 28.

Why it matters: Although S&P Global often maintains its full-year outlook after just one quarter, we believe that its quarterly results show resilience amid higher macroeconomic volatility.

The bottom line: While results were mostly in line with our expectations, we are reducing our fair value estimate for the wide-moat-rated firm to $530 from $570 as we calibrate our cost-of capital assumptions across our coverage universe. Absent this change, we would have maintained our fair value estimate.

- Specifically, we raised our cost of capital assumption to 7.7% from 7.3%.
- Separately, as we recalibrate our uncertainty ratings across our coverage universe, we are downgrading our uncertainty rating to Medium from Low. We believe this more accurately reflects variations in outcomes from macroeconomic variables and the rise of AI.

Between the lines: While AI disruption continues to be a concern for investors--we suspect that the debate will continue to play out for the foreseeable future--we see the AI conversation as broadening out from pure disruption concerns to more constructive commentary. S&P noted that a Market

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Sector
Financial Services

Industry
Financial Data & Stock Exchanges

Business Description

S&P Global provides data and benchmarks to capital and commodity market participants. Its ratings business is the largest credit rating agency in the world and S&P's largest segment by profitability. S&P's largest segment by revenue is market intelligence, which provides desktop, data and advisory solutions, enterprise solutions, and credit/risk solutions mostly in the financial-services industry. S&P's other segments include energy (formerly commodity insights, this segment includes Platts and other data), mobility (Carfax), and indexes. S&P plans to spin off mobility in 2026.

Intelligence client switched to its service from a competitor even though S&P was 20% more expensive due to its AI capabilities.

- In addition, S&P Global noted that growth among AI-utilizing customers in Market Intelligence is 30% higher than among non-AI customers, while in Energy it is roughly double. Admittedly, this may reflect self-selection rather than underlying performance differences, but is an intriguing datapoint.
- Though S&P Global did not quantify the impact, it still views AI efficiency as a contributing factor to operating margin expansion.

Business Strategy & Outlook Rajiv Bhatia, CFA, Equity Analyst, 28 Apr 2026

Whether through credit ratings, financial indexes, or commodity price reporting, S&P Global has established a wide moat from its data-driven benchmarks. Given the embedded nature of these benchmarks, S&P enjoys a strong competitive position and strong operating margins. In February 2022, S&P completed its $44 billion acquisition of IHS Markit. We believe IHS Markit's recurring revenue model diversified S&P's revenue, limiting upside and downside scenarios for the firm.

Bond issuance volume is a key revenue driver for S&P's ratings business, which makes up almost 40% of the firm's adjusted operating income. Over the long term, we believe high-single-digit revenue growth, driven by nominal GDP growth and pricing, is a reasonable expectation for this business. Regulatory issues are part of the backdrop of the firm's ratings business, but regulations can often benefit established players.

S&P's other segments include market intelligence (21% of adjusted operating income), S&P Dow Jones indexes (17%), energy (14%), and mobility (9%). S&P announced it will spin off its mobility division in 2026. While this business is moaty, in our view, we see limited synergy with S&P's other segments. Market intelligence revenue is recurring but faces stout competition from other providers such as Bloomberg, LSE Group (Refinitiv), and FactSet. The indexes segment revolves around the S&P 500 index and is monetized from index subscriptions to active asset managers, license fees for passive exchange-traded funds and mutual funds, and royalties from exchange-traded options and futures. Energy consists of S&P's legacy Platts business and IHS Markit's resources segment.

After spinning off its education business in 2013 and rebranding to S&P Global from McGraw Hill Financial, the firm has focused on expanding margins. Adjusted operating margin rose to 55% in 2021 from 34% in 2013, driven by streamlining operations and operating leverage, with strong interim revenue growth. However, given the inclusion of IHS Markit, which had some lower-margin businesses, we expect S&P Global's adjusted operating margins to normalize to the low 50s, below historical peaks.

Bulls Say Rajiv Bhatia, CFA, Equity Analyst, 28 Apr 2026

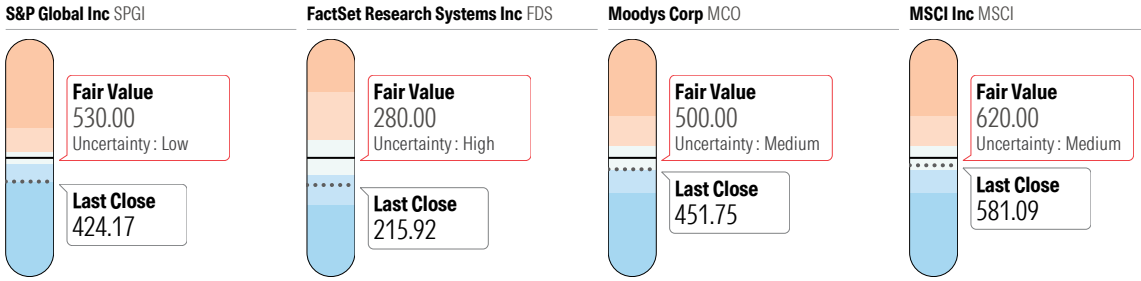
- Ratings revenue, which has high incremental margins, has often surprised to the upside, such as in

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Competitors



	S&P Global Inc SPGI	FactSet Research Systems Inc FDS	Moodys Corp MCO	MSCI Inc MSCI
Economic Moat	Wide	None	Wide	Wide
Currency	USD	USD	USD	USD
Fair Value	530.00 13 May 2026 16:23, UTC	280.00 13 May 2026 16:24, UTC	500.00 13 May 2026 16:25, UTC	620.00 13 May 2026 16:29, UTC
1-Star Price	662.50	434.00	675.00	837.00
5-Star Price	424.00	168.00	350.00	434.00
Assessment	Undervalued 13 May 2026	Undervalued 13 May 2026	Fairly Valued 13 May 2026	Fairly Valued 13 May 2026
Morningstar Rating	★★★★★13 May 2026 05:00, UTC	★★★★13 May 2026 05:00, UTC	★★★13 May 2026 05:00, UTC	★★★13 May 2026 05:00, UTC
Analyst	Rajiv Bhatia, Equity Analyst	Rajiv Bhatia, Equity Analyst	Rajiv Bhatia, Equity Analyst	Rajiv Bhatia, Equity Analyst
Capital Allocation	Exemplary	Standard	Exemplary	Exemplary
Price/Fair Value	0.77	0.72	0.88	0.92
Price/Sales	7.82	3.18	9.97	13.31
Price/Book	3.86	3.47	25.57	—
Price/Earning	25.71	12.99	31.42	32.59
Dividend Yield	0.91%	2.08%	0.86%	1.28%
Market Cap	120.34 Bil	7.35 Bil	76.56 Bil	41.56 Bil
52-Week Range	381.61—579.05	185.00—474.79	402.28—546.88	501.08—626.28
Investment Style	Large Blend	Small Blend	Mid Blend	Mid Growth

2020, 2021, and 2024. In addition, refinancing walls could support stronger than expected issuance.

- The spinoff of Mobility (Carfax) may strengthen management's focus and accelerate organic subscription revenue growth.
- S&P Global's benchmarks are difficult to displace and value-based pricing could result in a greater than expected pricing power and margin growth.

Bears Say Rajiv Bhatia, CFA, Equity Analyst, 28 Apr 2026

- Higher interest rates, corporate deleveraging, and increased spreads could lead to a decline in bond issuance, which would weigh on ratings revenue. Notably, spreads in 2024 and 2025 for high-yield were lower than usual, indicating relatively loose credit conditions.
- Market intelligence faces a variety of competitors such as FactSet, LSEG, and Bloomberg, and a tougher macro environment could elongate sales cycles. Also, the rise of AI could lower the barrier to entry for competitors.

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▶ The rise of private credit poses a challenge for rating agencies, as private credit is often unrated.

Economic Moat Rajiv Bhatia, CFA, Equity Analyst, 28 Apr 2026

We believe S&P Global's well-established benchmark businesses warrant a wide economic moat rating based on intangible assets and network effects.

Credit ratings provide value to bond issuers (such as corporate issuers) as well as bond investors, creating a network effect. Bond issuers value credit ratings from Moody's and S&P because of their wide acceptance among asset owners and asset managers. This is particularly important in cross-border bond issuance deals. While a local country's domestic rating agency could have value for its domestic bonds, a rating from a Big Three firm is critical for a cross-border marketed security, as global investors desire broad comparability across global bonds. For example, an investor wants to know that a B+ rating for a company in California is similar to a B+ rating for a company in Chile or a B+ rating for a company in India.

This broad acceptance makes it essential for corporate issuers to get a rating on any debt they issue. By getting a bond rating from a market leader such as S&P, the bond issuer pays less in interest (often 30-65 basis points in savings per year). The cost of a vanilla corporate bond credit rating costs around 8 basis points and is typically much less than the underwriting fees and legal fees (50-100 basis points combined).

It's not just bond investors and bond issuers who value credit ratings. In our view, acceptance among index providers and government regulators also supports the rating agencies' wide moats. For example, the Bloomberg Barclays US Aggregate Bond Index, which among other uses serves as the index for the $300 billion-plus BND exchange-traded fund, only considers ratings from either S&P, Moody's, or Fitch. Among banking regulators, rating agencies are used extensively to determine a bank's capital adequacy. Last, as the number of ratings increases, the value of ratings research subscriptions sold to buy-side investors increases.

Credit rating agencies such as S&P have built a moat through intangible assets as well. The incumbents are advantaged by their multidecade records, which allow investors to see how credit ratings performed. For example, it would be difficult for a new player to establish what the absolute and relative probabilities of a B versus BB versus BBB defaulting are over the next 10 years without sufficient sample size and time. Another hurdle for a new entrant would be establishing management relationships with the thousands of companies that issue debt. Given the strong record of incumbents, corporate management teams are unlikely to find much value in investing time and resources with another ratings provider.

Regulations provide another hurdle. To receive a nationally recognized statistical rating organization

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designation (which bestows many advantages) from the Securities and Exchange Commission, the agency must be nationally recognized, "meaning the rating agency is recognized in the United States as an issuer of credible and reliable ratings by the predominant users of securities markets." However, this creates a bit of a chicken-and-egg issue because for a rating agency to be credible according to capital market participants and corporate issuers, it's going to need to be an NRSRO. Even though the number of firms with an NRSRO designation has increased to about 10 since the introduction of the Credit Rating Agency Reform Act of 2006, we believe the network effect has been strong enough to result in limited traction for other rating agencies.

S&P has been able to leverage its moat to obtain solid pricing power, typically around 3%-4% per year. In 2026, S&P's rack rate for corporate finance ratings was 8.35 basis points, compared with 6.25 basis points in 2016 and 4.25 basis points in 2007, which implies fee compound annual growth rates of 3% and 4%, respectively.

S&P Dow Jones indexes has built a strong moat with its flagship benchmark, the S&P 500 index. S&P monetizes its indexes in primarily three ways: index subscriptions, asset-linked fees, and transaction royalties on exchange-traded futures and options. Active asset managers pay to benchmark performance against an index. Index benchmarks are critical to asset owners, asset managers, and consultants, which often have little incentive to switch. Once an index becomes dominant in a certain segment and has widespread acceptance among stakeholders, it tends to stay that way. An asset manager may prefer to be indexed against the Russell 1000, but if asset owners and consultants prefer the S&P 500, the asset manager would risk outflows. The largest ETFs in the US are based on the S&P 500 index, and we believe S&P Dow Jones has strong brand awareness among investors. Index switches tend to be rare in the ETF space and don't always move to a low cost for the provider. Finally, S&P generates trading royalties from exchange-traded derivatives, notably S&P 500 index futures on the CME, as well as S&P 500 index options and VIX options on the CBOE. Because of high trading volume, these index derivatives benefit from a network effect as they have the most liquidity. Also, S&P's exclusive agreements last many years (CBOE's agreement ends in 2032).

We view Platts, which is part of the commodity insights segment, as essentially an index business for certain commodities. Similar to how the S&P 500 dominates US large-cap equities and MSCI dominates international equities, typically one benchmark dominates a certain commodity. Moreover, Platts' prices are used in long-term contracts, thus guaranteeing the use of its prices for a certain period.

Commodity switching by market participants tends to be rare and is not usually driven by pricing. Rather, the infrequent switches we have noted seem more the result of concerns about price assessment volatility or methodology. Such was the case in 2011, when Malaysian state-owned oil company Petronas announced it would switch from local provider Asia Petroleum Price Index to Platts, citing volatility of the benchmark. Switches away from Platts have generally been over concerns about

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its adoption of market-on-close methodology. Though these switches benefited upstarts such as Argus, the use of market on close strongly boosted demand for its data subscriptions.

We view mobility as a wide-moat business based on intangible assets and switching costs. This segment houses Carfax, which provides used-vehicle history reports based on more than 25 billion records collected from more than 112,000 data sources. We believe it would be difficult for a new entrant to amass this data. In addition, we believe the Carfax brand is strong with consumers. We estimate the firm spends $40 million-$50 million in advertising for Carfax annually, an amount that would be difficult for an upstart to justify. In addition to Carfax, mobility serves the new-car market with data and analytics focusing on original equipment manufacturers, parts suppliers, and dealers. These solutions are integrated in customer workflows, and given that the price paid to S&P is only a small part of the client's overall costs, there is little incentive for carmakers to switch providers. In April 2025, S&P Global announced it plans to spin off this business into a separate public company.

We regard market intelligence as a narrow-moat business based on switching costs. S&P's desktop products include S&P Capital IQ and SNL. Data management solutions consists of similar data as desktops, but it's delivered by feeds and application programming interface rather than through a desktop. By being embedded in customer flows, customers face switching costs due to the hassle involved. That said, customers are not insensitive to price, and offerings are available from competitors such as FactSet and Refinitiv (owned by LSE Group). The credit risk solutions subsegment consists largely of selling credit ratings research subscriptions and data feeds, and we believe the moat here should be reflected in S&P ratings.

Fair Value and Profit Drivers Rajiv Bhatia, CFA, Equity Analyst, 28 Apr 2026

After updating our model following first-quarter financial results, we are decreasing our fair value estimate to $530 from $570 per share. The decrease is primarily due to raising our weighted average cost of capital to 7.7% from 7.3% as we calibrate our cost of capital assumptions across our coverage universe. Our fair value estimate, which is based on discounted cash flow analysis, equates to about 27 and 24 times our respective 2026 and 2027 non-GAAP earnings per share estimates. We continue to expect S&P to generate high-single-digit revenue growth in ratings through the cycle, driven by pricing and nominal GDP growth. We note that ratings revenue growth has been topsy-turvy historically as issuance levels have been volatile.

On a firmwide basis, we model average annual revenue growth of 7.3% per year between 2026-30. For market intelligence, we expect about 6% organic revenue growth driven by strong retention, new products, and market growth, which is in line with historical patterns. We believe that higher oil prices over time, coupled with pricing power, can lead to growth of around 8% per year in 2027-2030 at S&P Energy though the near-term might be weaker from Iran War-related disruptions. We see total index

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revenue growing 7%-9% per year after 2026, driven by growth in ETF AUM in the low-double-digits, partially offset by pricing compression.

By 2030, excluding the impact of the planned spinoff of the mobility division, we expect non-GAAP operating margin to be about 52.7%, about a 230-basis-point increase from 2025. We attribute the margin expansion to revenue growth and continued expense discipline. Specifically, S&P Global's businesses typically have limited variable costs, and thus our high-single-digit revenue forecast should allow for operating leverage.

Risk and Uncertainty Rajiv Bhatia, CFA, Equity Analyst, 28 Apr 2026

After calibrating our uncertainty ratings across our coverage universe, we assign a Medium Morningstar Uncertainty Rating to S&P Global versus Low previously. We believe this more accurately reflects S&P variation in outcomes from macroeconomic variables and the rise of AI.

With five different segments, S&P Global's operations are well diversified. From a geographic perspective, about 40% of revenue is recognized outside the US. Client concentration is minimal, and S&P clients span a wide variety of end markets.

The ratings business is the largest profit driver for S&P Global. In the near term, it is affected by the level of bond issuance, which can be lumpy. Longer-term, ratings revenue is driven by pricing power and GDP growth. This risk was seen in 2022 when ratings revenue declined by 26% and ratings adjusted profits declined by 35%.

Indexes' asset-linked fees, by contrast, are sensitive to asset price levels, specifically for ETFs. Trading royalties are sensitive to trading volume, and S&P Platts is modestly sensitive to energy market conditions.

While transaction-based ratings revenue can provide some volatility, we note that over 60% of S&P's revenue is subscription- or non-transaction-based.

From an environmental, social, and governance perspective, S&P has faced issues of rating efficacy. In 2015, S&P entered into a $1.38 billion settlement with the US Department of Justice and attorneys general from various states relating to civil claims on structured finance ratings. While issues like this crop up from time to time, we think S&P has been able to maintain its moat. Regulation also presents headline risk to the firm, but regulation often benefits incumbents, and thus far, S&P has been able to effectively pass on any increased regulatory and compliance costs to issuers. In addition, while AI threats have weighed on information services stocks, we struggle to see how their benchmark businesses (ratings, indexes, and Platts) will be disrupted.

Capital Allocation Rajiv Bhatia, CFA, Equity Analyst, 28 Apr 2026

In our view, S&P Global warrants an Exemplary Morningstar Capital Allocation Rating. We assess the

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firm's balance sheet as sound, its capital returns strategy as appropriate, and its investment decisions as decent.

S&P Global had $13.3 billion of debt on its balance sheet as of the end of March 2026, which translates to a gross debt/EBITDA ratio of 2.3 times. The firm generally targets a maximum gross leverage ratio of 2.5x. With a highly free-cash flow generative business model and conservative capitalization, we view the firm's balance sheet health as strong.

Turning to investments, the firm has done several acquisitions and divestitures over the years to strengthen and focus its portfolio of businesses since spinning off the education unit in 2013. By far, the largest of these was the $44 billion merger with IHS Markit. Overall, we do not think the firm overpaid for IHS Markit, but we note that the firm has divested or plans to divest a significant part of the firm since acquiring it. This suggests that strategic rationale and synergies with the acquired business were not that compelling. Most notably, the firm will spin off its Mobility (Carfax) segment in 2026. While we see this business as moaty, we see limited overlap with Mobility and S&P's other businesses, and view the divestiture as appropriate. From our vantage point, we view the IHS deal as lowering the volatility of S&P Financial's consolidated results, as IHS Markit's business skews heavily toward recurring revenue, in comparison to the highly incremental transaction-based revenue found in S&P's mainstay ratings segment.

Regarding shareholder distributions, S&P Global paid 22% of its adjusted earnings in dividends in 2025, which aligns with the company's target dividend payout ratio of 20%-30%. The bulk of S&P Global S&P's share repurchases have meaningfully decreased its shares outstanding and have been a driver of earnings growth. S&P increased its total capital returns target, which includes dividends and share purchases, to 85% from 75% following the merger with IHS Markit.

In November 2024, Martina Cheung took over as CEO following the retirement of Doug Peterson. Cheung was a logical choice, in our view, as she had experience in both the ratings and market intelligence segments, which are S&P's largest segments by profits and revenue, respectively. Peterson, who had been chief executive since 2013, avoided any serious pitfalls running the business and saw margins improve across his tenure. He also helped navigate the company out of litigation related to the financial crisis.

Analyst Notes Archive

Capital Markets Information Services and Software: Reviewing Our Moats for the Rise of AI Rajiv Bhatia, CFA,Equity Analyst,6 Mar 2026

Amid the possibility of generative AI disrupting many industries, we reviewed the moat ratings for an array of capital markets information services stocks, including Broadridge, Clearwater Analytics, FactSet, Fair Isaac, Moody's, MSCI, S&P Global, SS&C Technologies, and Verisk.Why it matters:

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S&P Global Inc SPGI ★★★★★ 13 May 2026 21:23, UTC

Last Price	Fair Value Estimate	Price/FVE	Market Cap	Economic Moat™	Equity Style Box	Uncertainty	Capital Allocation	ESG Risk Rating Assessment[1]
406.55 USD 13 May 2026	530.00 USD 28 Apr 2026 23:01, UTC	0.77	120.34 USD Bil 13 May 2026	Wide	Large Blend	Low	Exemplary	13 May 2026 05:00, UTC

Generative artificial intelligence is affecting these firms through many vectors, adding a degree of uncertainty that demands careful consideration. Generative AI lowers barriers to entry in the compilation of nonproprietary data and creation of software, which may now require more investment spending, changing the investing landscape. Overall, we do not expect generative AI to disrupt network effect-based moats. Credit ratings, financial and commodity indexes, and credit scores are data-driven benchmarks that are embedded throughout their respective industries. Another theme is that proprietary data often protects a firm's moat. Examples include credit ratings (credit ratings are based on nonpublic information provided by management teams) and Verisk's contributory insurance data on claims and insurance losses.The bottom line: After considering factors such as competitive positioning, pricing models, and the prevalence of proprietary data, we are maintaining our wide moat ratings for Broadridge, Fair Isaac, Moody's, MSCI, S&P Global, and Verisk. We are maintaining our narrow moat rating on Clearwater Analytics. We downgraded our moat rating to none from narrow for FactSet and SS&C Technologies.Between the lines: Market fears related to AI-related headwinds tie to long-term growth and terminal values, in our view. As a result, strong current performance and confident management commentary may not assuage investor fears. AI may not be a net negative if it increases data usage, as AI makes it easier to analyze data. S&P Global recently mentioned that it had 80 clients for a model context protocol mostly related to the firm's market intelligence segment, for example.

S&P Global Earnings: Market Reacts Negatively to Relatively Modest Misses, Ratings Outlook Rajiv Bhatia, CFA,Equity Analyst,10 Feb 2026

S&P Global finished 2025 with solid 9% growth in fourth-quarter revenue and 14% growth in adjusted earnings per share, but the firm's initial 2026 outlook of adjusted EPS of $19.53 missed FactSet consensus estimates of $20.02, driving a 6% share price drop in Feb. 10 intraday trading.Why it matters: We attribute the negative reaction to a few revenue blips in the quarter and a slightly weaker-than-expected ratings outlook, with little impact on our long-term view. During the quarter, billed issuance was up 28%, but transaction ratings revenue was up 12% as the firm saw softness in higher revenue-yielding bank loan ratings revenue. Despite market tailwinds, such as elevated deal activity and low spreads spurring bond issuance, the firm guided to just 4%-7% ratings revenue growth, below the firm's 6%-9% medium-term target unveiled at its November 2025 investor day for that segment.The bottom line: As we review these results, we maintain our fair value estimate of $570 for wide-moat S&P Global. We see shares as undervalued; we had anticipated that 2026 would be a tough year for bond issuance growth, given the challenging comparison. Furthermore, we see the firm's pricing power in its wide-moat ratings business as intact. We note that shares were down as much as 18% in premarket trading, symptomatic of a jittery market that has exhibited a propensity for sharp swings and knee-jerk reactions to relatively modest misses. Amid the release of Claude's Opus 4.6 model, designed to carry out financial research, markets have been increasingly concerned about AI disruption. Our view is that S&P Market Intelligence clients still have meaningful switching costs; we see S&P's proprietary

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benchmarks (ratings, indexes, Platts) as insulated from AI disruption.Bulls say: Bond issuance can continue to impress, driven by accommodative conditions and refinancing needs. Much of the high-yield debt issued during the issuance boom of 2020 and 2021 is coming due in 2027 and 2028.

Information Services: AI Bear Case Continues to Weigh on Stocks Rajiv Bhatia, CFA,Equity Analyst,3 Feb 2026

In intraday trading on Feb. 3, a broad group of information-services companies, such as rating agencies, data providers, index providers, credit bureaus, and others, are seeing share price declines of 5% or more.Why it matters: We attribute this to two factors. First, Anthropic released an artificial intelligence-enabled plug-in designed to automate legal workflows. Second, Gartner posted a disappointing revenue and earnings per share outlook. It expects 2026 revenue of $6.46 billion (FactSet consensus: $6.71 billion) and adjusted EPS of $12.30 (consensus: $13.53). While there have been many AI-focused startups in the legal space, Anthropic's plug-in suggests that its models can be customized for a specific industry. As a result, bears fear that models such as Anthropic will disrupt a host of information-services verticals. Gartner's second-quarter results last year appeared to be a tipping point for the AI bear case on information-services stocks. While that weak quarter may have been affected by a weaker macroeconomic outlook and the loss of some government revenue, the shares dropped 28% that day (Aug. 5) on fears that the rise of generative AI was eating into the firm's core insights business.The bottom line: We are maintaining our fair value estimates and moat ratings for our information-services stocks, including rating agencies (Moody's, S&P Global), index providers (MSCI), data providers (Verisk, FactSet), and credit bureaus/scores (Equifax, TransUnion, Experian, and Fair Isaac).Long view: We view wide-moat-rated firms with proprietary and mission-critical data, as well as those with network effect-driven benchmark businesses, as mostly insulated from AI disruption-related risk. For example, we see credit ratings, indexes, Verisk's insurance data, and FICO scores as benefiting from a network effect. Even if a better solution emerges, their use in contracts and in the capital markets would require complex coordination to disrupt, in our view.

S&P Global: Ratings Disclosures Continue to Show Solid Pricing Power Rajiv Bhatia, CFA,Equity Analyst,6 Jan 2026

Our perusal of S&P Ratings disclosures indicates that its list price on most US corporate transactions as of January 2026 is 8.35 basis points with a minimum fee of $155,000; this is 3.1% higher than the 8.10 basis points list price in January 2025.Why it matters: The 0.25-basis-point increase is a slight acceleration from the 0.20-basis-point increases seen in 2025 and 2024. The minimum fee compares with $145,000 and $140,000 in 2025 and 2024, respectively.The bottom line: We will maintain our fair value estimates on S&P Global and Moody's of $570 and $550, respectively, as S&P's disclosures are consistent with our view that the leading rating agencies can typically increase pricing in the 3% to 4% range per year. We believe this pricing power is indicative of wide moats in the ratings business

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stemming from a network effect among market participants and intangible assets from their long track record.The big picture: The transaction fee is just one element to rating agency pricing. In addition to the published transaction rate, ratings agencies such as S&P, Moody's, and Fitch can adjust their pricing on credit monitoring or surveillance fees, sundry fees, and frequent issuer programs. For 2026, Fitch's EMEA corporate issuance fees are 7.80 basis points (first EUR 1.5 billion) and 6.80 basis points thereafter. This is modestly higher than last year's 7.70 and 6.70 basis points, respectively. That said, the minimum went up to EUR 75,000 from EUR 63,000, and fees for hybrid and complex securities increased to 9.00 basis points from 8.50 basis points. Fitch is also taking meaningful pricing action on surveillance and sundry fees. Surveillance fees for debt sized between EUR 1 billion and EUR 2 billion are up 5.4% to EUR 88,500 per year, for example.

S&P Global: Investor Day Targets Mostly In Line With Our Model; $570 Fair Value Maintained Rajiv Bhatia, CFA,Equity Analyst,14 Nov 2025

On Nov. 13, 2025, S&P Global's investor day had updated financial targets to include medium-term (three- to five-year annual average) firmwide organic revenue growth of 7%-9%, including 6%-8% at Market Intelligence. Shares rose 1.5%, edging out a a1.7% decline in the Morningstar US Market Index.Why it matters: Fears that artificial intelligence is a negative on information services companies have weighed on their stocks recently. We are encouraged by the positive market reaction to the 6%-8% organic revenue growth outlook at Market Intelligence, as investor concerns are greatest here. In addition to enhancing its products with AI capabilities, private markets continue to be a big focus. S&P Global seeks to solve the "transparency gap" between private and public markets by providing data, benchmarks, and workflow tools for private market assets. Examples include private market indexes at S&P Dow Jones indexes, private credit ratings and estimates, and its acquisition of With Intelligence, which provides deal sourcing and diligence solutions.The bottom line: As we digest these results, we maintain our wide moat rating on S&P Global, as well as our fair value estimate of $570 per share. We see shares as modestly undervalued at current levels. In S&P Ratings, which is the firm's largest profit driver. S&P Global expects 6%-9% revenue growth over the medium term. This aligns with our 2027-29 average growth rate of 8%. Our forecast is primarily driven by GDP and pricing. S&P Global expects 50-75 basis points of margin expansion, which we view as reasonable, based on operating leverage and faster growth in higher-margin segments such as indexes. We model for about 55 basis points on average from 2025 to 2029.

S&P Global Earnings: Strong Results in Multiple Segments; Maintaining Our $570 Fair Value Estimate Rajiv Bhatia, CFA,Equity Analyst,30 Oct 2025

S&P Global reported strong third-quarter revenue and moved the midpoint of its revenue outlook higher across multiple segments. Margins grew in all the firm's segments, and it raised its firmwide margin outlook. Shares popped 4% during Oct. 30 intraday trading.Why it matters: We view the positive market

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reaction as largely attributable to Market Intelligence organic revenue growth, which accelerated to 7.6% annually from 6.5% a quarter ago and from 5.3% in the first quarter. Year-over-year ratings revenue growth of 12% matched Moody's, and the indexes business benefiting from record market levels, but those results were more easily foreseeable. Peers LSEG and FactSet have seen roughly stable annual growth in recent quarters, so the acceleration in Market Intelligence growth is encouraging. Fears that generative artificial intelligence could commoditize nonproprietary data collection and software production, potentially impacting end user counts have weighed on information services stocks such as LSEG and FactSet. Addressing these concerns directly, management noted that just 12% of Market Intelligence's revenue is from data that is "publicly available and not materially enhanced by S&P Global." Though there is some debate as to what truly is proprietary, this is lower than we would have expected.Bottom line: As we incorporate these results, we will maintain our fair value estimate of $570. We view S&P Global's data-driven benchmark businesses such as ratings, indexes, and Platts, as having network-effect-driven wide moats from their use by multiple stakeholders. We continue to see shares as modestly undervalued. From a multiples perspective, shares currently trade at 26 times forward earnings, which is a discount from the three-year and five-year averages of 29 times and 30 times, respectively.Coming Up: S&P Global will host an investor day on Nov. 13, 2025.

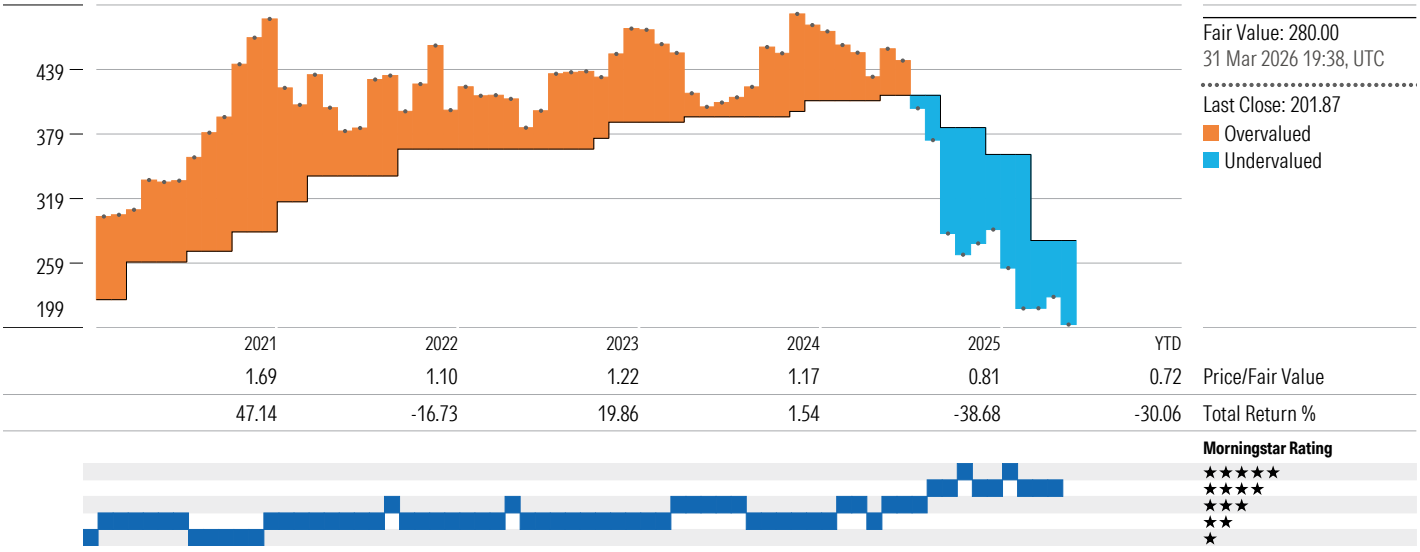
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Competitors Price vs. Fair Value

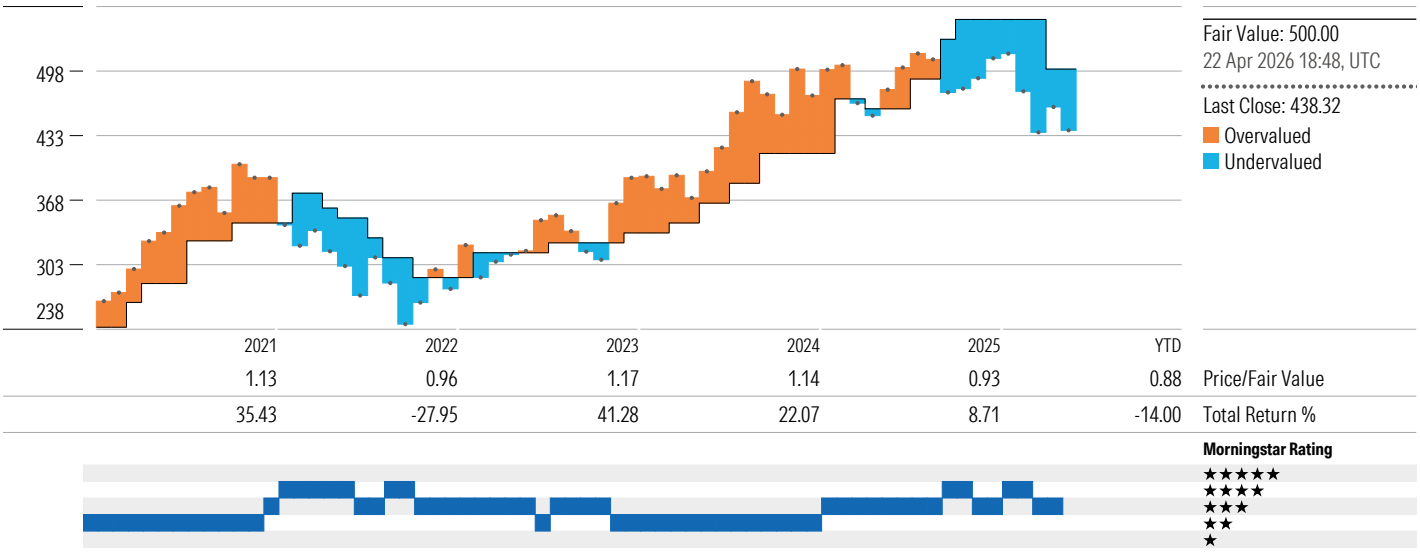
FactSet Research Systems Inc FDS



	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	YTD	
	1.69	1.10	1.22	1.17	0.81	0.72	Price/Fair Value
	47.14	-16.73	19.86	1.54	-38.68	-30.06	Total Return %

Total Return % as of 13 May 2026. Last Close as of 13 May 2026. Fair Value as of 31 Mar 2026 19:38, UTC.

Moodys Corp MCO



	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	YTD	
	1.13	0.96	1.17	1.14	0.93	0.88	Price/Fair Value
	35.43	-27.95	41.28	22.07	8.71	-14.00	Total Return %

Total Return % as of 13 May 2026. Last Close as of 13 May 2026. Fair Value as of 22 Apr 2026 18:48, UTC.

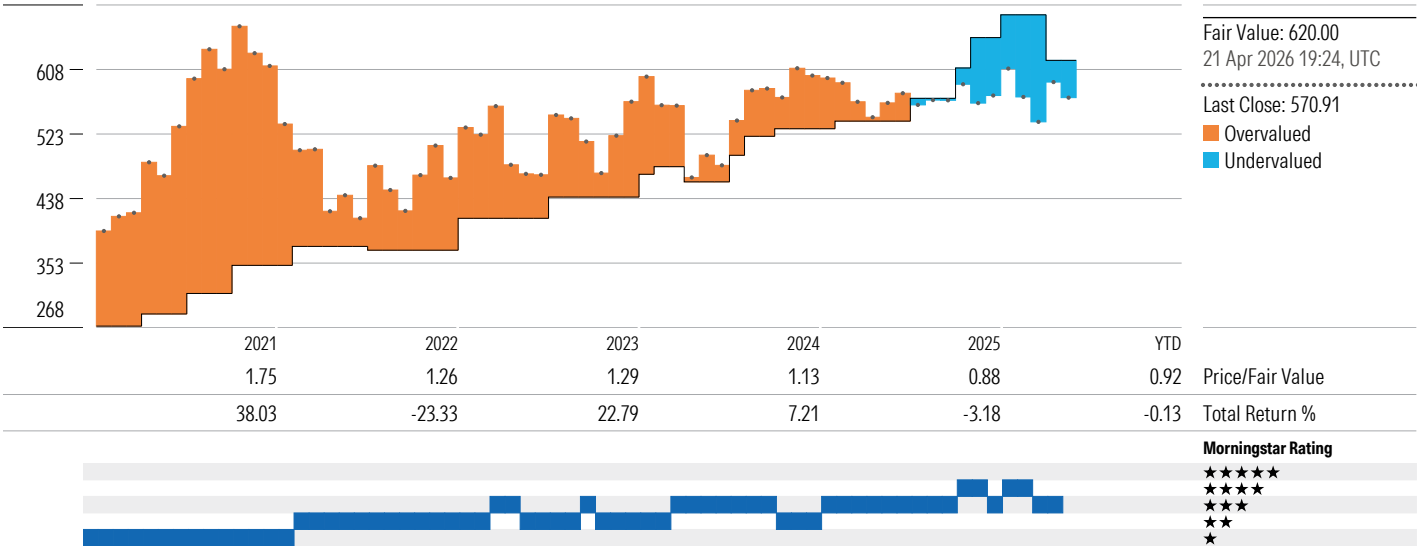
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Competitors Price vs. Fair Value

MSCI Inc MSCI



	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	YTD
Price/Fair Value	1.75	1.26	1.29	1.13	0.88	0.92
Total Return %	38.03	-23.33	22.79	7.21	-3.18	-0.13

Total Return % as of 13 May 2026. Last Close as of 13 May 2026. Fair Value as of 21 Apr 2026 19:24, UTC.

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Morningstar Valuation Model Summary

Financials as of 28 Apr 2026	Actual			Forecast				
Fiscal Year, ends 31 Dec	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026**	**2027**	**2028**	**2029**	**2030**
Revenue (USD Mil)	12,497	14,208	15,336	16,536	17,684	18,996	20,397	21,827
Operating Income (USD Mil)	4,054	5,478	6,478	7,260	7,934	8,826	9,762	10,710
EBITDA (USD Mil)	5,148	6,778	7,657	8,405	9,009	9,838	10,714	11,607
Adjusted EBITDA (USD Mil)	5,148	6,778	7,657	8,405	9,009	9,838	10,714	11,607
Net Income (USD Mil)	2,626	3,852	4,499	5,010	5,525	6,201	6,908	7,631
Adjusted Net Income (USD Mil)	4,019	4,898	5,285	5,838	6,299	6,925	7,585	8,264
Free Cash Flow To The Firm (USD Mil)	4,382	4,952	4,717	6,332	6,494	7,040	7,642	8,275
Weighted Average Diluted Shares Outstanding (Mil)	319	312	305	298	289	280	271	263
Earnings Per Share (Diluted) (USD)	8.23	12.35	14.75	16.83	19.11	22.13	25.49	29.06
Adjusted Earnings Per Share (Diluted) (USD)	12.60	15.70	17.32	19.61	21.79	24.71	27.98	31.47
Dividends Per Share (USD)	3.60	3.64	3.84	4.22	4.65	5.11	5.62	6.18

Margins & Returns as of 28 Apr 2026		Actual			Forecast					
	3 Year Avg	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026**	**2027**	**2028**	**2029**	**2030**	**5 Year Avg**
Operating Margin %	37.9	32.4	38.6	42.2	43.9	44.9	46.5	47.9	49.1	46.4
EBITDA Margin %	—	41.2	47.7	49.9	50.8	50.9	51.8	52.5	53.2	—
Adjusted EBITDA Margin %	—	41.2	47.7	49.9	50.8	50.9	51.8	52.5	53.2	51.8
Net Margin %	25.8	21.0	27.1	29.3	30.3	31.2	32.7	33.9	35.0	32.6
Adjusted Net Margin %	33.7	32.2	34.5	34.5	35.3	35.6	36.5	37.2	37.9	36.5
Free Cash Flow To The Firm Margin %	33.6	35.1	34.8	30.8	38.3	36.7	37.1	37.5	37.9	37.5

Growth & Ratios as of 28 Apr 2026		Actual			Forecast					
	3 Year CAGR	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026**	**2027**	**2028**	**2029**	**2030**	**5 Year CAGR**
Revenue Growth %	11.1	11.8	13.7	7.9	7.8	6.9	7.4	7.4	7.0	7.3
Operating Income Growth %	29.0	34.3	35.1	18.3	12.1	9.3	11.3	10.6	9.7	10.6
EBITDA Growth %	10.1	-14.5	31.7	13.0	9.8	7.2	9.2	8.9	8.3	8.7
Adjusted EBITDA Growth %	8.4	-14.5	31.7	13.0	9.8	7.2	9.2	8.9	8.3	8.7
Earnings Per Share Growth %	13.1	-19.3	50.0	19.4	14.1	13.6	15.8	15.2	14.0	14.5
Adjusted Earnings Per Share Growth %	13.1	12.6	24.6	10.3	13.2	11.1	13.4	13.2	12.5	14.5

Valuation as of 28 Apr 2026	Actual			Forecast				
	2023	**2024**	**2025**	**2026**	**2027**	**2028**	**2029**	**2030**
Price/Earning	35.0	31.7	30.2	20.7	18.7	16.5	14.5	12.9
Price/Sales	11.2	10.8	10.2	7.3	6.8	6.3	5.9	5.5
Price/Book	4.1	4.7	5.1	3.9	3.8	3.7	3.5	3.3
Price/Cash Flow	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
EV/EBITDA	29.1	24.1	21.7	15.7	14.7	13.4	12.3	11.4
EV/EBIT	37.0	29.9	25.7	18.2	16.7	15.0	13.6	12.4
Dividend Yield %	0.8	0.7	0.7	1.0	1.1	1.3	1.4	1.5
Dividend Payout %	28.6	23.2	22.2	21.5	21.3	20.7	20.1	19.7
Free Cash Flow Yield %	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—

Operating Performance / Profitability as of 28 Apr 2026	Actual			Forecast				
Fiscal Year, ends 31 Dec	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026**	**2027**	**2028**	**2029**	**2030**
ROA %	4.3	6.4	7.4	8.3	9.1	10.3	11.4	12.4
ROE %	6.9	10.3	12.4	14.0	15.3	17.3	19.1	20.5
ROIC %	5.8	7.9	9.3	10.4	11.6	13.0	14.5	16.1

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S&P Global Inc SPGI ★★★★★ 13 May 2026 21:23, UTC

Last Price	Fair Value Estimate	Price/FVE	Market Cap	Economic Moat™	Equity Style Box	Uncertainty	Capital Allocation	ESG Risk Rating Assessment[1]
406.55 USD 13 May 2026	530.00 USD 28 Apr 2026 23:01, UTC	0.77	120.34 USD Bil 13 May 2026	Wide	Large Blend	Low	Exemplary	13 May 2026 05:00, UTC

Financial Leverage (Reporting Currency)	Actual			Forecast				
Fiscal Year, ends 31 Dec	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026**	**2027**	**2028**	**2029**	**2030**
Debt/Capital %	7.9	7.2	7.9	7.1	6.6	6.1	5.7	5.2
Assets/Equity	1.6	1.6	1.7	1.7	1.7	1.7	1.7	1.6
Net Debt/EBITDA	2.1	1.5	1.5	1.3	1.0	0.9	0.7	0.5
Total Debt/EBITDA	2.3	1.8	1.8	1.5	1.3	1.2	1.0	0.9
EBITDA/ Net Interest Expense	15.4	22.8	26.7	21.3	23.9	27.2	31.0	35.3

Forecast Revisions as of 28 Apr 2026	2026		2027		2028	
Prior data as of 13 Feb 2026	**Current**	**Prior**	**Current**	**Prior**	**Current**	**Prior**
Fair Value Estimate Change (Trading Currency)	530.00	572.14	—	—	—	—
Revenue (USD Mil)	16,536	16,404	17,684	17,643	18,996	18,957
Operating Income (USD Mil)	7,260	7,027	7,934	7,849	8,826	8,717
EBITDA (USD Mil)	8,405	8,137	9,009	8,893	9,838	9,700
Net Income (USD Mil)	5,838	5,641	6,299	6,210	6,925	6,819
Earnings Per Share (Diluted) (USD)	16.83	16.26	19.11	18.89	22.13	21.84
Adjusted Earnings Per Share (Diluted) (USD)	19.61	18.95	21.79	21.48	24.71	24.34
Dividends Per Share (USD)	4.22	4.22	4.65	4.65	5.11	5.11

Key Valuation Drivers as of 28 Apr 2026

Cost of Equity %	7.9
Pre-Tax Cost of Debt %	5.3
Weighted Average Cost of Capital %	7.7
Long-Run Tax Rate %	—
Stage II EBI Growth Rate %	6.4
Stage II Investment Rate %	15.1
Perpetuity Year	20

Additional estimates and scenarios available for download at https://pitchbook.com/.

Discounted Cash Flow Valuation as of 28 Apr 2026

	USD Mil
Present Value Stage I	24,497
Present Value Stage II	69,489
Present Value Stage III	69,179
Total Firm Value	**163,164**
Cash and Equivalents	1,745
Debt	13,088
Other Adjustments	0
Equity Value	**151,821**
Projected Diluted Shares	293
Fair Value per Share (USD)	**530.00**

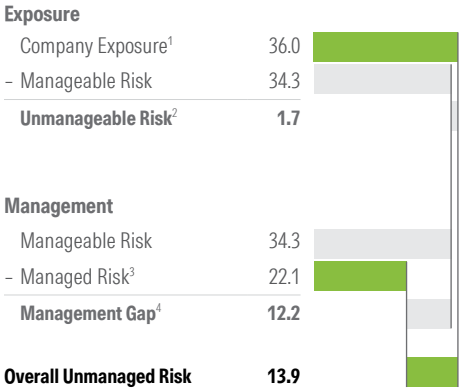
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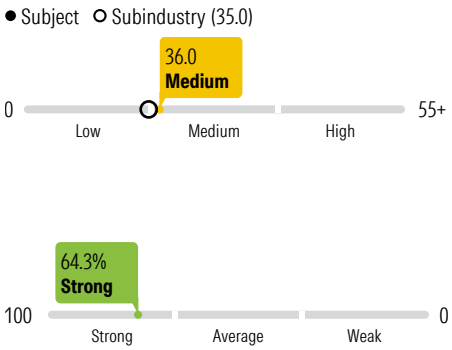
MORNINGSTAR®

S&P Global Inc SPGI ★★★★★ 13 May 2026 21:23, UTC

Last Price	Fair Value Estimate	Price/FVE	Market Cap	Economic Moat™	Equity Style Box	Uncertainty	Capital Allocation	ESG Risk Rating Assessment[1]
406.55 USD 13 May 2026	530.00 USD 28 Apr 2026 23:01, UTC	0.77	120.34 USD Bil 13 May 2026	Wide	Large Blend	Low	Exemplary	13 May 2026 05:00, UTC

ESG Risk Rating Breakdown





- Exposure represents a company's vulnerability to ESG risks driven by their business model
- Exposure is assessed at the Subindustry level and then specified at the company level
- Scoring ranges from 0-55+ with categories of low, medium, and high-risk exposure

- Management measures a company's ability to manage ESG risks through its commitments and actions
- Management assesses a company's efficiency on ESG programs, practices, and policies
- Management score ranges from 0-100% showing how much manageable risk a company is managing

ESG Risk Rating



ESG Risk Ratings measure the degree to which a company's value is impacted by environmental, social, and governance risks, by evaluating the company's ability to manage the ESG risks it faces.

1. A company's Exposure to material ESG issues 2. Unmanageable Risk refers to risks that are inherent to a particular business model that cannot be managed by programs or initiatives 3. Managed Risk = Manageable Risk multiplied by a Management score of 64.3% 4. Management Gap assesses risks that are not managed, but are considered manageable 5. ESG Risk Rating Assessment = Overall Unmanaged Risk = Management Gap plus Unmanageable Risk

ESG Risk Rating Assessment[5]



ESG Risk Rating is of May 13, 2026. Highest Controversy Level is as of May 08, 2026. Sustainalytics Subindustry: Financial Exchanges and Data Services. Sustainalytics provides Morningstar with company ESG ratings and metrics on a monthly basis and as such, the ratings in Morningstar may not necessarily reflect current Sustainalytics' scores for the company. For the most up to date rating and more information, please visit: sustainalytics.com/esg-ratings/.

Peer Analysis 13 May 2026

Peers are selected from the company's Sustainalytics-defined Subindustry and are displayed based on the closest market cap values

Company Name	Exposure			Management			ESG Risk Rating		
S&P Global Inc	36.0 | Medium	0	55+	64.3 | Strong	100	0	13.9 | Low	0	40+
FactSet Research Systems Inc	36.0 | Medium	0	55+	55.1 | Strong	100	0	17.1 | Low	0	40+
Moodys Corp	36.0 | Medium	0	55+	62.2 | Strong	100	0	14.6 | Low	0	40+
MSCI Inc	32.7 | Low	0	55+	59.5 | Strong	100	0	14.1 | Low	0	40+
Hongta Securities Co Ltd	40.7 | Medium	0	55+	30.4 | Average	100	0	28.8 | Medium	0	40+

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Appendix

Historical Morningstar Rating

S&P Global Inc SPGI 13 May 2026 05:00, UTC

Dec 2026	Nov 2026	Oct 2026	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Jul 2026	Jun 2026	May 2026	Apr 2026	Mar 2026	Feb 2026	Jan 2026
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Dec 2025	Nov 2025	Oct 2025	Sep 2025	Aug 2025	Jul 2025	Jun 2025	May 2025	Apr 2025	Mar 2025	Feb 2025	Jan 2025
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Dec 2024	Nov 2024	Oct 2024	Sep 2024	Aug 2024	Jul 2024	Jun 2024	May 2024	Apr 2024	Mar 2024	Feb 2024	Jan 2024
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Dec 2021	Nov 2021	Oct 2021	Sep 2021	Aug 2021	Jul 2021	Jun 2021	May 2021	Apr 2021	Mar 2021	Feb 2021	Jan 2021
★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★★★	★★	★★	★★	★★★	★★

FactSet Research Systems Inc FDS 13 May 2026 05:00, UTC

Dec 2026	Nov 2026	Oct 2026	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Jul 2026	Jun 2026	May 2026	Apr 2026	Mar 2026	Feb 2026	Jan 2026
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Dec 2025	Nov 2025	Oct 2025	Sep 2025	Aug 2025	Jul 2025	Jun 2025	May 2025	Apr 2025	Mar 2025	Feb 2025	Jan 2025
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Dec 2022	Nov 2022	Oct 2022	Sep 2022	Aug 2022	Jul 2022	Jun 2022	May 2022	Apr 2022	Mar 2022	Feb 2022	Jan 2022
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Dec 2021	Nov 2021	Oct 2021	Sep 2021	Aug 2021	Jul 2021	Jun 2021	May 2021	Apr 2021	Mar 2021	Feb 2021	Jan 2021
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Moodys Corp MCO 13 May 2026 05:00, UTC

Dec 2026	Nov 2026	Oct 2026	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Jul 2026	Jun 2026	May 2026	Apr 2026	Mar 2026	Feb 2026	Jan 2026
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Dec 2024	Nov 2024	Oct 2024	Sep 2024	Aug 2024	Jul 2024	Jun 2024	May 2024	Apr 2024	Mar 2024	Feb 2024	Jan 2024
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Dec 2023	Nov 2023	Oct 2023	Sep 2023	Aug 2023	Jul 2023	Jun 2023	May 2023	Apr 2023	Mar 2023	Feb 2023	Jan 2023
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Dec 2022	Nov 2022	Oct 2022	Sep 2022	Aug 2022	Jul 2022	Jun 2022	May 2022	Apr 2022	Mar 2022	Feb 2022	Jan 2022
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Dec 2021	Nov 2021	Oct 2021	Sep 2021	Aug 2021	Jul 2021	Jun 2021	May 2021	Apr 2021	Mar 2021	Feb 2021	Jan 2021
★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★★

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MSCI Inc MSCI 13 May 2026 05:00, UTC

Dec 2026	Nov 2026	Oct 2026	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Jul 2026	Jun 2026	May 2026	Apr 2026	Mar 2026	Feb 2026	Jan 2026
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Dec 2025	Nov 2025	Oct 2025	Sep 2025	Aug 2025	Jul 2025	Jun 2025	May 2025	Apr 2025	Mar 2025	Feb 2025	Jan 2025
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Dec 2024	Nov 2024	Oct 2024	Sep 2024	Aug 2024	Jul 2024	Jun 2024	May 2024	Apr 2024	Mar 2024	Feb 2024	Jan 2024
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Dec 2023	Nov 2023	Oct 2023	Sep 2023	Aug 2023	Jul 2023	Jun 2023	May 2023	Apr 2023	Mar 2023	Feb 2023	Jan 2023
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Dec 2022	Nov 2022	Oct 2022	Sep 2022	Aug 2022	Jul 2022	Jun 2022	May 2022	Apr 2022	Mar 2022	Feb 2022	Jan 2022
★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★★	★	★
Dec 2021	Nov 2021	Oct 2021	Sep 2021	Aug 2021	Jul 2021	Jun 2021	May 2021	Apr 2021	Mar 2021	Feb 2021	Jan 2021
★	★	★	★	★	★	★	★	★	★	★	★

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Research Methodology for Valuing Companies

Overview

At the heart of our valuation system is a detailed projection of a company's future cash flows, resulting from our analysts' research. Analysts create custom industry and company assumptions to feed income statement, balance sheet, and capital investment assumptions into our globally standardized, proprietary discounted cash flow, or DCF, modeling templates. We use scenario analysis, indepth competitive advantage analysis, and a variety of other analytical tools to augment this process. Moreover, we think analyzing valuation through discounted cash flows presents a better lens for viewing cyclical companies, high-growth firms, businesses with finite lives (e.g., mines), or companies expected to generate negative earnings over the next few years. That said, we don't dismiss multiples altogether but rather use them as supporting cross-checks for our DCF-based fair value estimates. We also acknowledge that DCF models offer their own challenges (including a potential proliferation of estimated inputs and the possibility that the method may miss shortterm market-price movements), but we believe these negatives are mitigated by deep analysis and our longterm approach.

Morningstar's equity research group ("we," "our") believes that a company's intrinsic worth results from the future cash flows it can generate. The Morningstar Rating for stocks identifies stocks trading at a discount or premium to their intrinsic worth—or fair value estimate, in Morningstar terminology. Five-star stocks sell for the biggest risk adjusted discount to their fair values, whereas 1-star stocks trade at premiums to their intrinsic worth.

Four key components drive the Morningstar rating: (1) our assessment of the firm's economic moat, (2) our estimate of the stock's fair value, (3) our uncertainty around that fair value estimate and (4) the current market price. This process ultimately culminates in our singlepoint star rating.

1. Economic Moat

The concept of an economic moat plays a vital role not only in our qualitative assessment of a firm's long-term investment potential, but also in the actual calculation of our fair value estimates. An economic moat is a structural feature that allows a firm to sustain excess profits over a long period of time. We define economic profits as returns on invested capital (or ROIC) over and above our estimate of a firm's cost of capital, or weighted average cost of capital (or WACC). Without a moat, profits are more susceptible to competition. We have identified five sources of economic moats: intangible assets, switching costs, network effect, cost advantage, and efficient scale.

Companies with a narrow moat are those we believe are more likely than not to achieve normalized excess returns for at least the next 10 years. Wide-moat companies are those in which we have very high confidence that excess returns will remain for 10 years, with excess returns more likely than not to remain for at least 20 years. The longer a firm generates economic profits, the higher its intrinsic value. We believe low-quality, no-moat companies will see their normalized returns gravitate toward the firm's cost of capital more quickly than companies with moats.

When considering a company's moat, we also assess whether there is a substantial threat of value destruction, stemming from risks related to ESG, industry disruption, financial health, or other idiosyncratic issues. In this context, a risk is considered potentially value destructive if its occurrence would eliminate a firm's economic profit on a cumulative or midcycle basis. If we deem the probability of occurrence sufficiently high, we would not characterize the company as possessing an economic moat.

2. Estimated Fair Value

Combining our analysts' financial forecasts with the firm's economic moat helps us assess how long returns on invested capital are likely to exceed the firm's cost of capital. Returns of firms with a wide economic moat rating are assumed to fade to the perpetuity period over a longer period of time than the returns of narrow-moat firms, and both will fade slower than no-moat firms, increasing our estimate of their intrinsic value.

Our model is divided into three distinct stages:

Stage I: Explicit Forecast

In this stage, which can last five to 10 years, analysts make full financial statement forecasts, including items such as revenue, profit margins, tax rates, changes in workingcapital accounts, and capital spending. Based on these projections, we calculate earnings before interest, after taxes (EBI) and the net new investment (NNI) to derive our annual free cash flow forecast.

Stage II: Fade

The second stage of our model is the period it will take the company's return on new invested capital—the return on capital of the next dollar invested ("RONIC")—to decline (or rise) to its cost of capital. During the Stage II period, we use a formula to approximate cash flows in lieu of explicitly modeling the income statement, balance sheet, and cash flow statement as we do in Stage I. The length of the second stage depends on the strength of the company's economic moat. We forecast this period to last anywhere from one year (for companies with no economic moat) to 10–15 years or more (for wide-moat companies). During this period, cash flows are forecast using four assumptions: an average growth rate for EBI over the period, a normalized investment rate, average return on new invested capital (RONIC), and the number of years until perpetuity, when excess returns cease. The investment rate and return on new invested capital decline until a perpetuity value is calculated. In the case of firms that do not earn their cost of capital, we assume marginal ROICs rise to the firm's cost of capital (usually attributable to less reinvestment), and we may truncate the second stage.

Stage III: Perpetuity

Once a company's marginal ROIC hits its cost of capital, we calculate a continuing value, using a standard perpetuity formula. At perpetuity, we assume that any growth or decline or investment in the business neither creates nor destroys value and that any new investment provides a return in line with estimated WACC.

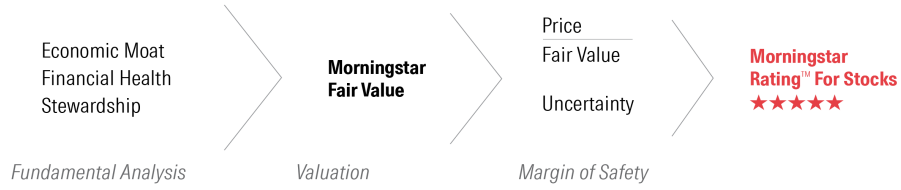
Because a dollar earned today is worth more than a dollar earned tomorrow, we discount our projections of cash flows in stages I, II, and III to arrive at a total present value of expected future cash flows. Because we are modeling free cash flow to the firm—representing cash available to provide a return to all capital providers—we discount future cash flows using the WACC, which is a weighted average of the costs of equity, debt, and preferred stock (and any other funding sources), using expected future proportionate long-term, market-value weights.

3. Uncertainty Around That Fair Value Estimate

Morningstar's Uncertainty Rating is designed to capture the range of potential outcomes for a company's intrinsic value. This rating is used to assign the margin of safety required before investing, which in turn explicitly drives our stock star rating system. The Uncertainty Rating is aimed at identifying the confidence we should have in assigning a fair value estimate for a given stock.

Our Uncertainty Rating is meant to take into account anything that can increase the potential dispersion of future

Morningstar Equity Research Star Rating Methodology



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Research Methodology for Valuing Companies

outcomes for the intrinsic value of a company, and anything that can affect our ability to accurately predict these outcomes. The rating begins with a suggested rating produced by a quantitative process based on the trailing 12-month standard deviation of daily stock returns. An analyst overlay is then applied, with analysts using the suggested rating, historical rating data, and their own knowledge of the company to inform them as they make the final Uncertainty Rating decision. Ultimately, the rating decision rests with the analyst. Analysts take into account many characteristics when making their final decision, including cyclical factors, operational and financial factors such as leverage, company-specific events, ESG risks, and anything else that might increase the potential dispersion of future outcomes and our ability to estimate those outcomes.

Our recommended margin of safety—the discount to fair value demanded before we'd recommend buying or selling the stock—widens as our uncertainty of the estimated value of the equity increases. The more uncertain we are about the potential dispersion of outcomes, the greater the discount we require relative to our estimate of the value of the firm before we would recommend the purchase of the shares. In addition, the Uncertainty Rating provides guidance in portfolio construction based on risk tolerance.

Our Uncertainty Ratings are: Low, Medium, High, Very High, and Extreme.

	Margin of Safety	
Qualitative Analysis Uncertainty Ratings	★★★★★Rating	★Rating
Low	20% Discount	25% Premium
Medium	30% Discount	35% Premium
High	40% Discount	55% Premium
Very High	50% Discount	75% Premium
Extreme	75% Discount	300% Premium

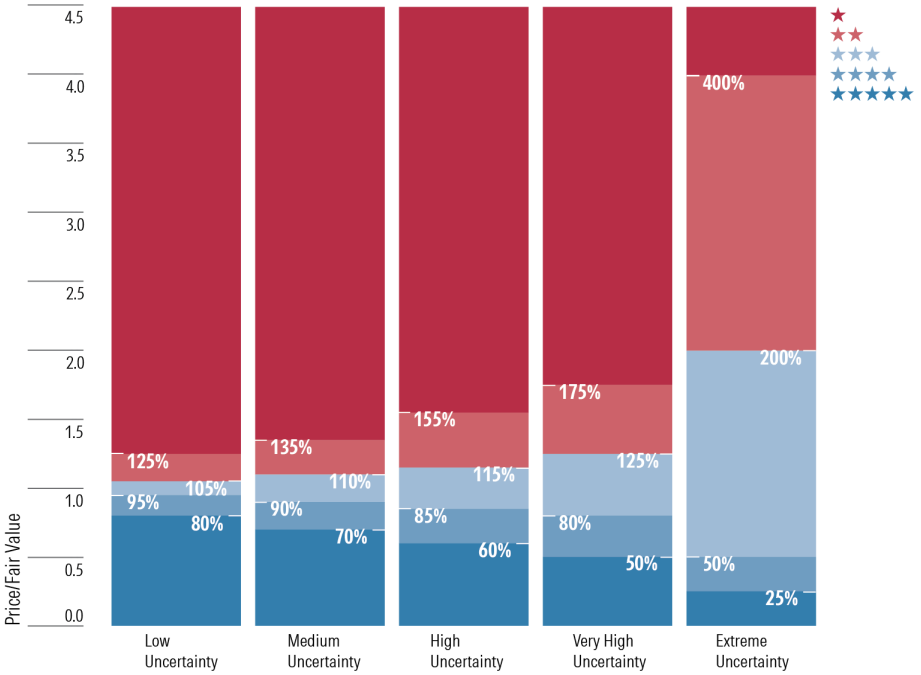
Our uncertainty rating is based on the interquartile range, or the middle 50% of potential outcomes, covering the 25th percentile–75th percentile. This means that when a stock hits 5 stars, we expect there is a 75% chance that the intrinsic value of that stock lies above the current market price. Similarly, when a stock hits 1 star, we expect there is a 75% chance that the intrinsic value of that stock lies below the current market price.

4. Market Price

The market prices used in this analysis and noted in the report come from exchange on which the stock is listed which we believe is a reliable source.

For more details about our methodology, please go to https://shareholders.morningstar.com

Morningstar Equity Research Star Rating Methodology



Morningstar Star Rating for Stocks

Once we determine the fair value estimate of a stock, we compare it with the stock's current market price on a daily basis, and the star rating is automatically re-calculated at the market close on every day the market on which the stock is listed is open. Our analysts keep close tabs on the companies they follow, and, based on thorough and ongoing analysis, raise or lower their fair value estimates as warranted.

Please note, there is no predefined distribution of stars. That is, the percentage of stocks that earn 5 stars can fluctuate daily, so the star ratings, in the aggregate, can serve as a gauge of the broader market's valuation. When there are many 5-star stocks, the stock market as a whole is more undervalued, in our opinion, than when very few companies garner our highest rating.

We expect that if our base-case assumptions are true the market price will converge on our fair value estimate over time generally within three years (although it is impossible to predict the exact time frame in which market prices may adjust).

Our star ratings are guideposts to a broad audience and individuals must consider their own specific investment goals, risk tolerance, tax situation, time horizon, income needs, and complete investment portfolio, among other factors.

The Morningstar Star Ratings for stocks are defined below:

★★★★★ We believe appreciation beyond a fair risk adjusted return is highly likely over a multiyear time frame. Scenario analysis developed by our analysts indicates that the current market price represents an excessively pessimistic outlook, limiting downside risk and maximizing upside potential.

★★★★ We believe appreciation beyond a fair risk-adjusted return is likely.

★★★ Indicates our belief that investors are likely to receive a fair risk-adjusted return (approximately cost of equity).

★★ We believe investors are likely to receive a less than fair risk-adjusted return.

★ Indicates a high probability of undesirable risk-adjusted returns from the current market price over a multiyear time frame, based on our analysis. Scenario analysis by our analysts indicates that the market is pricing in an excessively optimistic outlook, limiting upside potential and leaving the investor exposed to Capital loss.

Other Definitions

Last Price: Price of the stock as of the close of the market of the last trading day before date of the report.

Capital Allocation Rating: Our Capital Allocation (or Stewardship) Rating represents our assessment of the quality of management's capital allocation, with particular emphasis on the firm's balance sheet, investments,

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and shareholder distributions. Analysts consider companies' investment strategy and valuation, balance sheet management, and dividend and share buyback policies. Corporate governance factors are only considered if they are likely to materially impact shareholder value, though either the balance sheet, investment, or shareholder distributions. Analysts assign one of three ratings: "Exemplary", "Standard", or "Poor". Analysts judge Capital Allocation from an equity holder's perspective. Ratings are determined on a forward looking and absolute basis. The Standard rating is most common as most managers will exhibit neither exceptionally strong nor poor capital allocation.

Capital Allocation (or Stewardship) analysis published prior to Dec. 9, 2020, was determined using a different process. Beyond investment strategy, financial leverage, and dividend and share buyback policies, analysts also considered execution, compensation, related party transactions, and accounting practices in the rating.

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Sustainalytics' ESG Risk Ratings measure the degree to which company's economic value at risk is driven by environment, social and governance (ESG) factors.

Sustainalytics analyzes over 1,300 data points to assess a company's exposure to and management of ESG risks. In other words, ESG Risk Ratings measures a company's unmanaged ESG Risks represented as a quantitative score. Unmanaged Risk is measured on an open-ended scale starting at zero (no risk) with lower scores representing less unmanaged risk and, for 95% of cases, the unmanaged ESG Risk score is below 50.

Based on their quantitative scores, companies are grouped into one of five Risk Categories (negligible, low, medium, high, severe). These risk categories are absolute, meaning that a 'high risk' assessment reflects a comparable degree of unmanaged ESG risk across all subindustries covered.

The ESG Risk Rating Assessment is a visual representation of Sustainalytics ESG Risk Categories on a 1 to 5 scale. Companies with Negligible Risk = 5 Globes, Low Risk = 4, Medium Risk = 3 Globes, High Risk = 2 Globes, Severe Risk = 1 Globe. For more information, please visit sustainalytics.com/esg-ratings/

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